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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 3 : Session – 8 | Limits to Growth and the Real Problem

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. 'LIMITS TO GROWTH' (1972, Club of Rome) was a landmark computer-simulation study (World3 model at MIT) that showed: if growth trends in population, industrialisation, pollution, food production and resource depletion continue unchanged, the limits to growth on this planet will be reached within a hundred years, followed by decline. Its key message: unlimited material growth on a finite planet is impossible — the 'growth forever' assumption itself must be questioned. It was one of the first scientific warnings that the dominant development model is unsustainable.
2. Q2. 'The problem is NOT JUST POPULATION' means: a large population WITH right understanding can live prosperously within nature's limits (assessed needs, right utilisation, cyclical production), while even a small population WITHOUT right understanding — with unlimited consumption, exploitation and domination — destroys the planet (e.g., the richest 10% consume the majority of resources). The real variable is the human ASSUMPTION and conduct, not headcount alone. Hence population control without human education cannot solve the crisis; the number matters far less than the manner of living.
3. Q3. SYMPTOMATIC approaches to sustainability: carbon offsets that let consumption continue, fines for polluters that are cheaper than compliance, green marketing without redesigning production — all treat the surface. SAMADHAN approaches: (1) clarity that inhuman conduct (assumption 'physical facility is everything') is the root cause; (2) effort through human education, human conduct, human constitution and human order; (3) analysing each problem in the light of that clarity; (4) ensuring conduct through education. The first set manages symptoms; the second set eliminates the cause.
4. Q4. FIVE personal actions toward the solution: (1) RIGHT UTILISATION — assess my real needs and consume only that much (no impulse buying, minimal food waste). (2) CYCLICAL PRACTICE — segregate waste, compost organics, reuse and recycle so my consumption returns to nature's cycle. (3) RESOURCE RESTRAINT — save water and electricity deliberately (bucket bath, switching off, harvesting rainwater where possible). (4) PARTICIPATION — plant and nurture trees, support local natural farming and community initiatives. (5) SELF-EXPLORATION — daily examine my desires: are they from sensation/preconditioning or natural acceptance? — so that my conduct stays guided by right understanding rather than market-driven want.